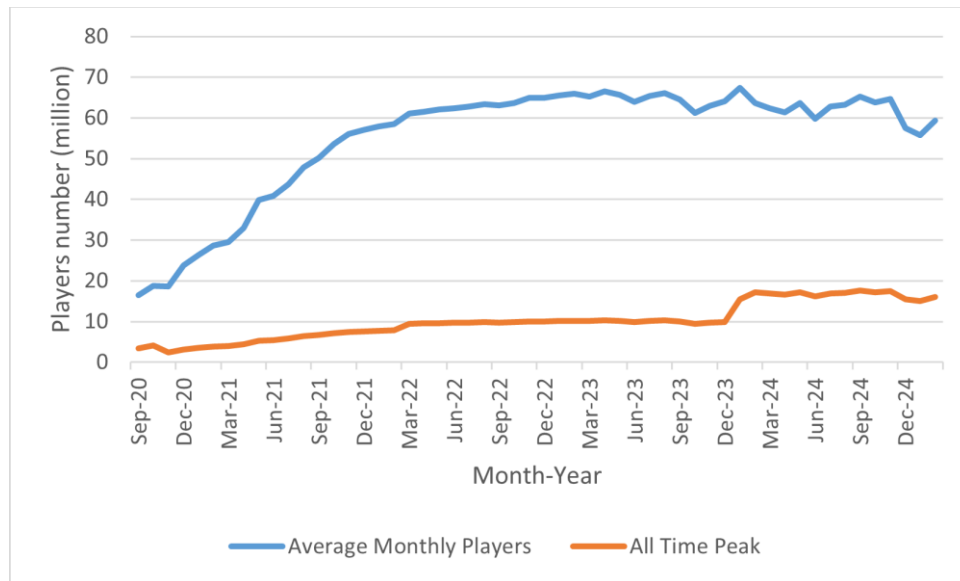


Appendix

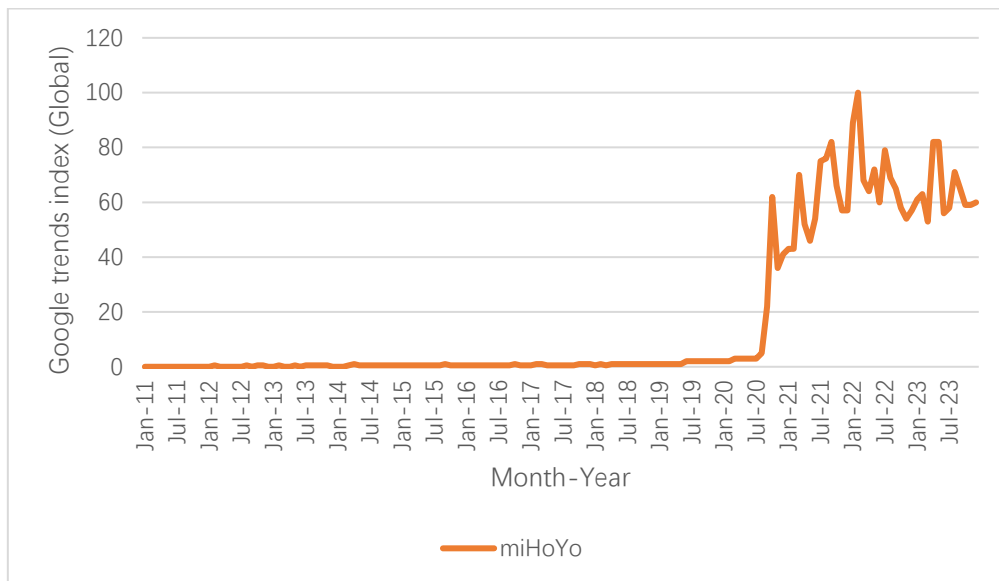
Appendix A



Appendix Figure A1: Genshin Impact's monthly active players

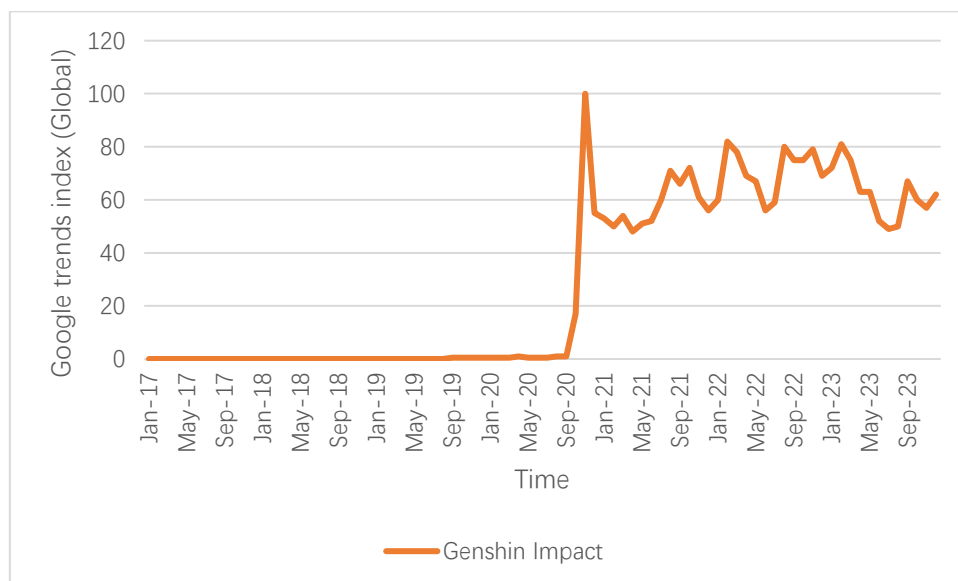
Source: ActivePlayer

Appendix B



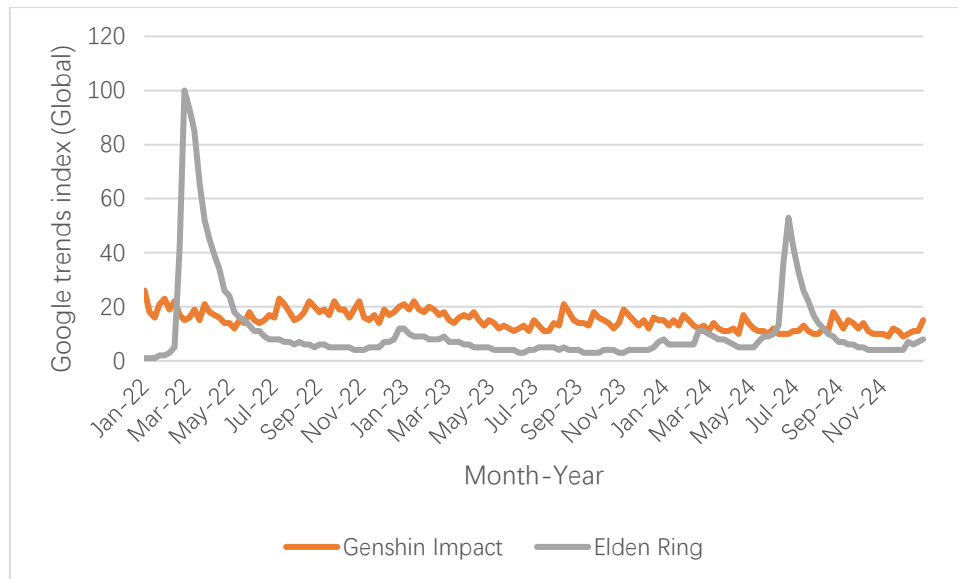
Appendix Figure B1: miHoYo's global popularity

Source: Google trends



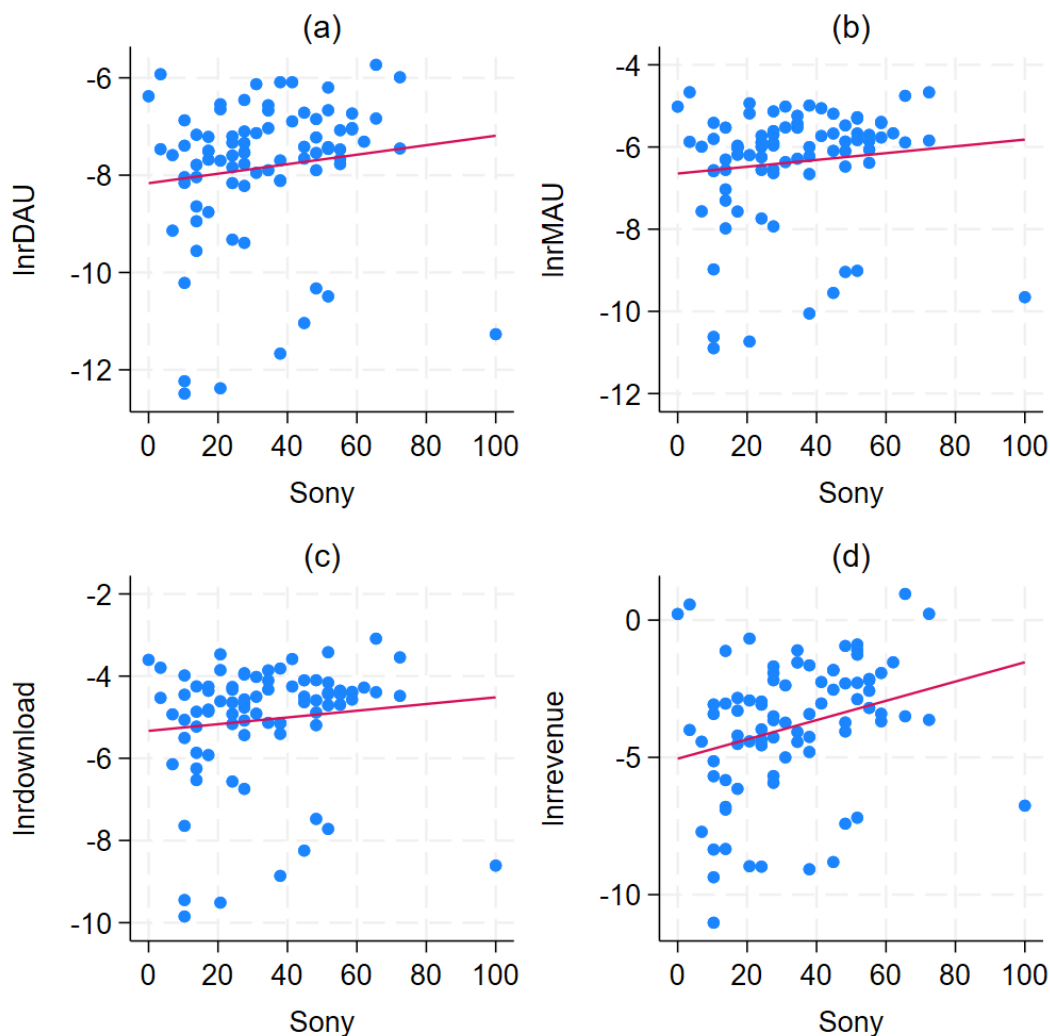
Appendix Figure B2: Genshin Impact's global popularity

Source: Google trends



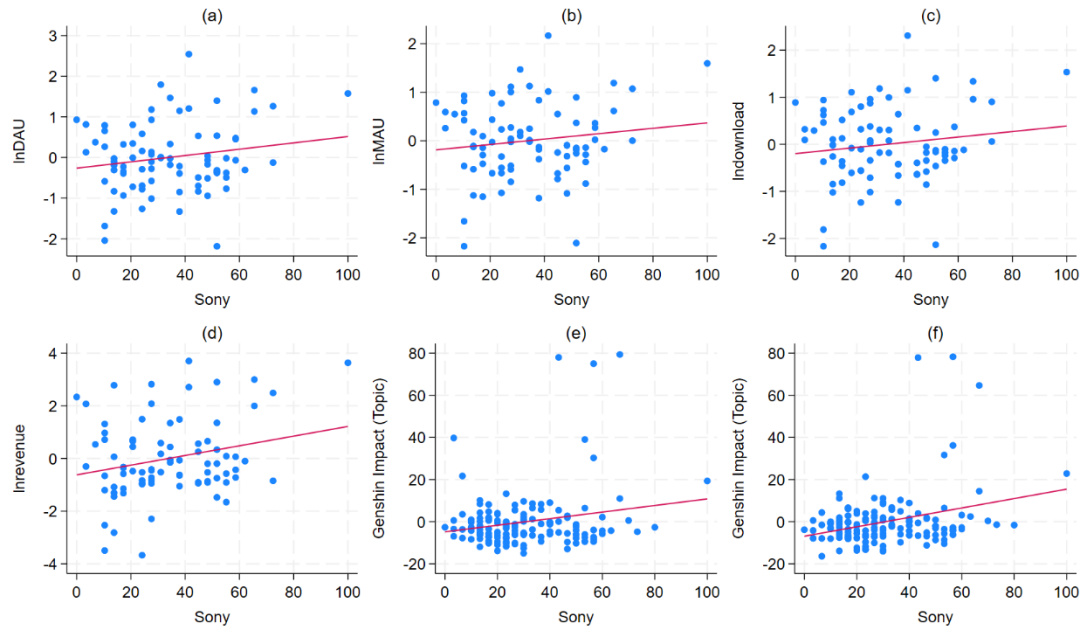
Appendix Figure B3: A comparison of the global popularity of Genshin Impact and Elden Ring

Source: Google trends



Appendix Figure B4: The correlation between Sony GTI and Genshin Impact

Note: The horizontal axis represents the topic "Sony" GTI of various countries prior to the study period (July 2019 to March 2020). In panel (a), the vertical axis represents the logarithm of per capita DAU (Daily Active Users) of Genshin Impact in each country during the study period (April 2020 to June 2021). In panel (b), the vertical axis represents the logarithm of per capita MAU (Monthly Active Users) of Genshin Impact in each country. In panel (c), the vertical axis represents the logarithm of per capita total downloads of Genshin Impact in each country. In panel (d), the vertical axis represents the logarithm of per capita total revenue of Genshin Impact in each country. The population size is based on the total population of each country in 2019.



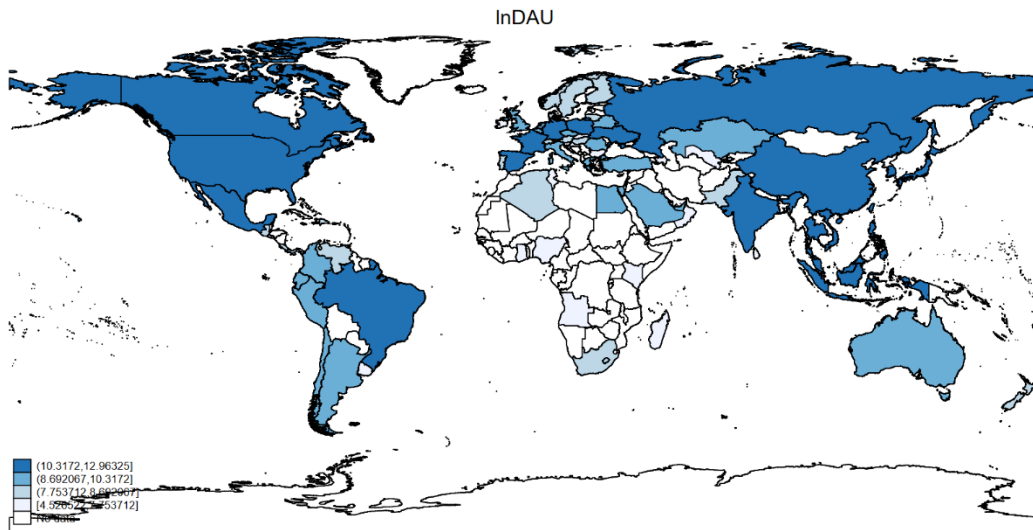
Appendix Figure B5: The correlation between Sony GTI and Genshin Impact (Adding control variables)

Note: Appendix Figure B5 and Figure 2 are identical to the main figures, with the additional control of the logarithm of GDP, the logarithm of GDP per capita, the logarithm of fixed broadband internet users, and the fixed broadband internet user density (per 100 people).

Appendix C

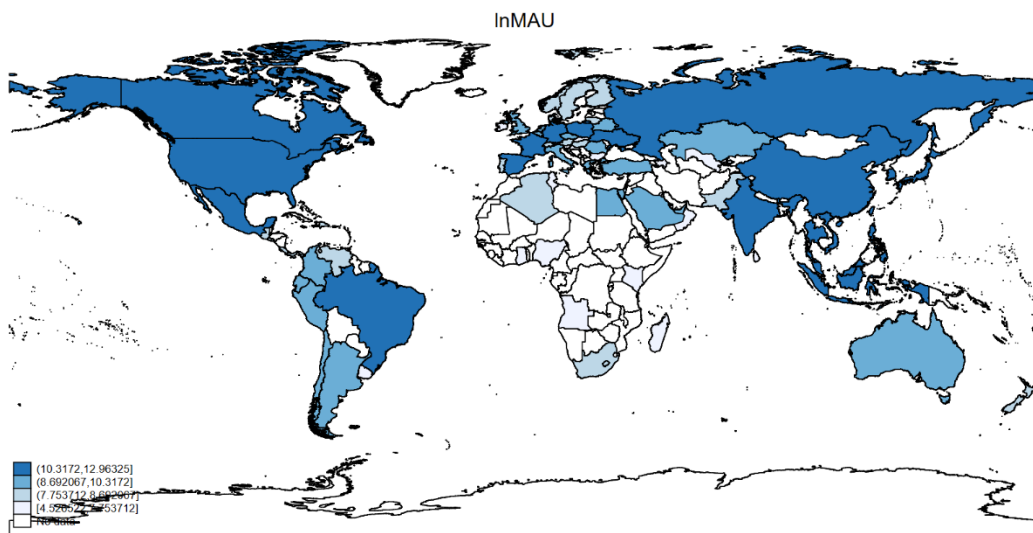
Appendix Table C1: Descriptive statistics of key variables

Variable	Obs	Mean	Std. dev.	Min	Max
<i>lnexport</i>	2,115	19.3006	2.0360	10.1990	24.6744
<i>Sony</i>	2,115	30.8747	18.0998	0	100
<i>lnconfirmed</i>	2,115	10.4191	2.6593	0.8109	17.3298
<i>lndeaths</i>	2,115	6.5173	2.7226	0	13.2981
<i>confirmed_rate</i>	2,115	1.3366	2.3253	4.19E-06	17.8856
<i>crude mortality rate</i>	2,115	0.0258	0.0438	0	0.3096
<i>case fatality rate</i>	2,115	2.8394	3.1717	0	29.1371
<i>lngdp</i>	2,115	25.0884	1.9290	20.9228	30.5379
<i>lnrgdp</i>	2,115	8.7490	1.4934	5.3379	11.6179
<i>lninternet</i>	2,115	13.1441	2.6778	5.2679	18.5525
<i>internet_rate</i>	2,115	15.0637	14.6186	0.0013	47.1313



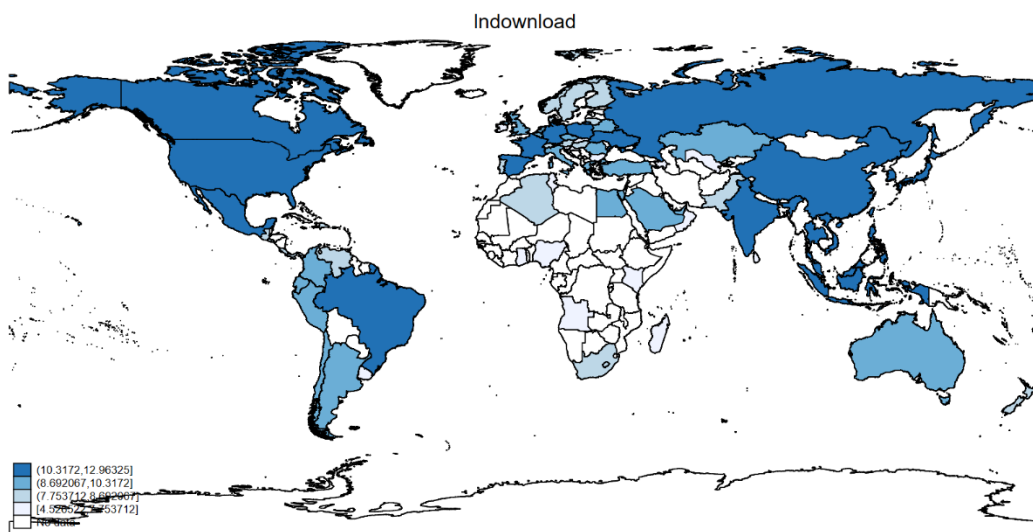
Appendix Figure C1: Country-level Genshin Impact DAU (ln)

Source: Sensor Tower



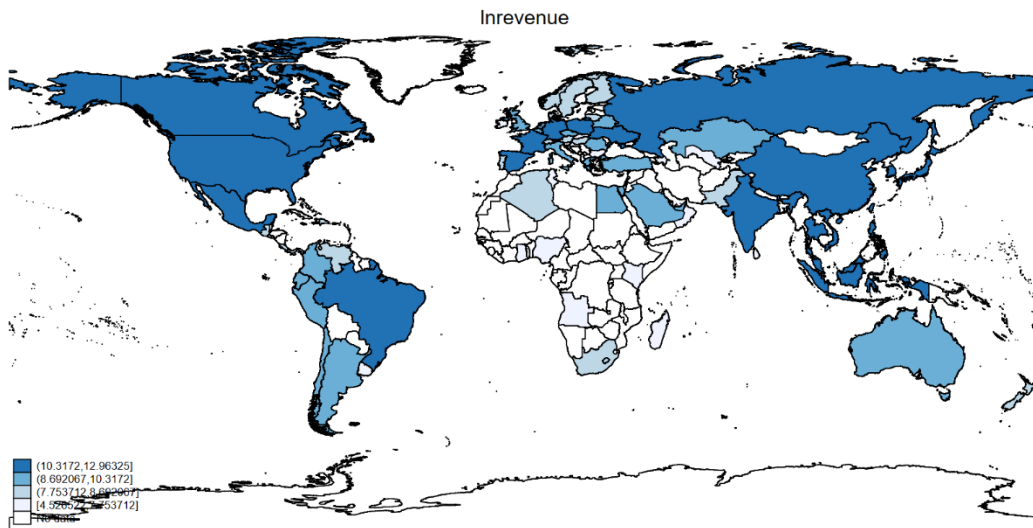
Appendix Figure C2: Country-level Genshin Impact MAU (ln)

Source: Sensor Tower



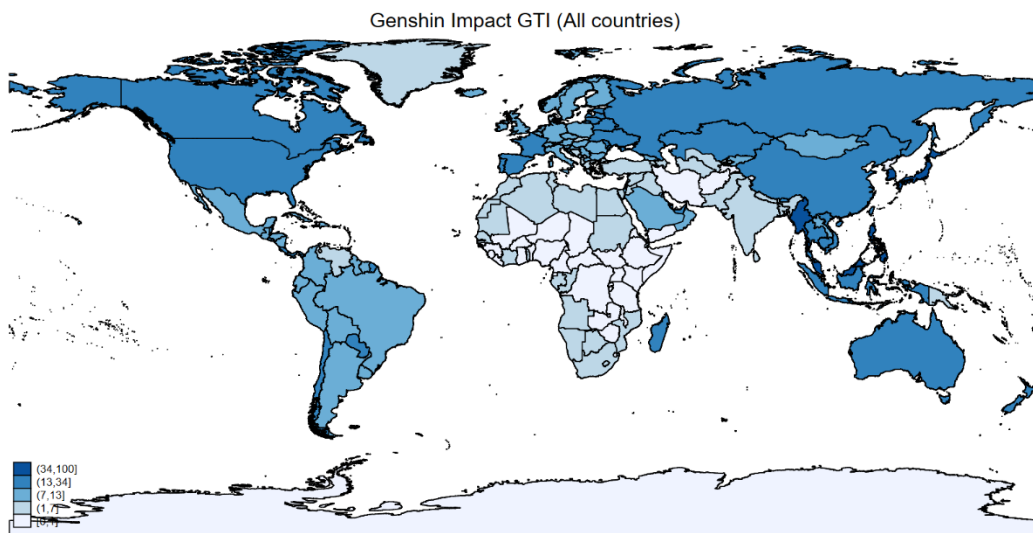
Appendix Figure C3: Country-level Genshin Impact download (ln)

Source: Sensor Tower



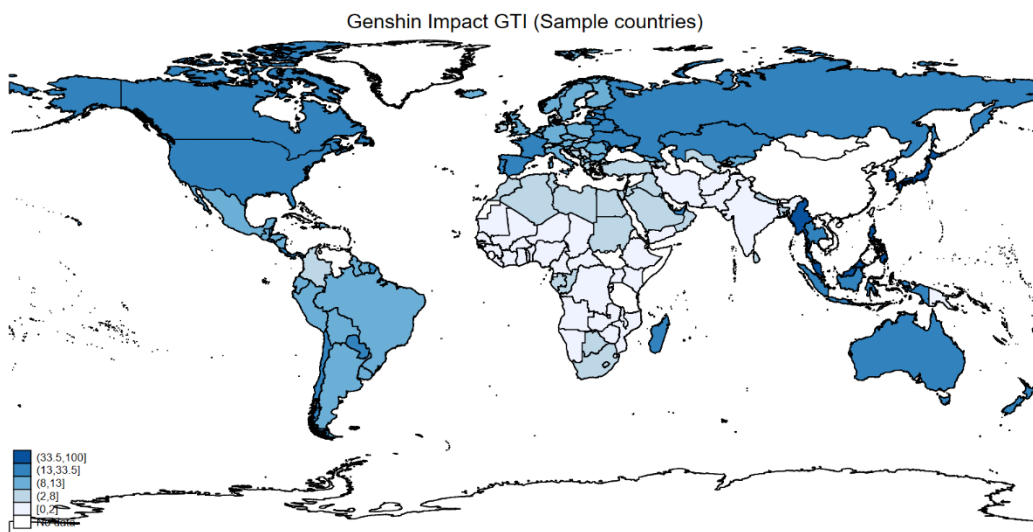
Appendix Figure C4: Country-level Genshin Impact revenue (ln)

Source: Sensor Tower



Appendix Figure C5: Country-level Genshin Impact GTI (All countries)

Source: Sensor Tower



Appendix Figure C6: Country-level Genshin Impact GTI (Sample countries)

Source: Sensor Tower

Appendix D

Appendix Table D1: The results of replacing search period and search type

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)
Search period	201907- 202003	201907- 201912	201901- 201912	201801- 202003	201801- 201912	201701- 202003	201701- 201912
Panel A: topic	<i>lnexport</i>						
<i>Sony</i> × <i>Post</i>	0.186** (0.0832)	0.186** (0.0917)	0.179** (0.0894)	0.171** (0.0799)	0.187** (0.0848)	0.186** (0.0874)	0.187** (0.0887)
Covid19 controls	√	√	√	√	√	√	√
X ₂₀₁₉ ×Month FE	√	√	√	√	√	√	√
Country FE	√	√	√	√	√	√	√
Month FE	√	√	√	√	√	√	√
Observations	2,115	2,115	2,115	2,115	2,115	2,115	2,115
R-squared	0.991	0.990	0.990	0.991	0.991	0.991	0.991
Panel B: term	<i>lnexport</i>						
<i>Sony</i> × <i>Post</i>	0.358*** (0.0954)	0.410*** (0.104)	0.447*** (0.124)	0.396*** (0.104)	0.389*** (0.103)	0.308*** (0.0908)	0.301*** (0.0903)
Covid19 controls	√	√	√	√	√	√	√
X ₂₀₁₉ ×Month FE	√	√	√	√	√	√	√
Country FE	√	√	√	√	√	√	√
Month FE	√	√	√	√	√	√	√
Observations	2,115	2,115	2,115	2,115	2,115	2,115	2,115
R-squared	0.991	0.991	0.991	0.991	0.991	0.991	0.991

Note: The values in parentheses represent country level clustered robust standard errors. The variables *Sony* is absorbed by the country fixed effects. The variable *Post* is absorbed by the month fixed effects. In the regression, we multiply dependent variable *lnexport* by 100 to directly interpret the core estimated coefficient as a semi-elasticity. Covid19 controls include the number of confirmed cases, deaths, the case confirmation rate (i.e., the number of confirmed cases divided by the total population), the crude mortality rate (i.e., the number of deaths divided by the total population), and the case fatality rate (i.e., the number of deaths divided by the number of confirmed cases). **X**₂₀₁₉ includes the logarithm of GDP, the logarithm of GDP per capita, the logarithm of fixed broadband internet users, and the fixed broadband internet user density (per 100 people). *, **, and *** indicate statistical significance at the 10%, 5%, and 1% levels, respectively.

Appendix Table D2: The results of controlling for China's exports prior to the study period

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
	<i>lnexport</i>					
<i>Sony</i> × <i>Post</i>	0.188** (0.0831)	0.185** (0.0847)	0.185** (0.0847)	0.180** (0.0845)	0.184** (0.0839)	0.176** (0.0835)
<i>lnexport</i> _{<i>c,t</i>} (<i>L1</i>)				6.963 (4.426)		
<i>lnexport</i> _{<i>c,t</i>} (<i>L12</i>)					12.73* (7.096)	
<i>lnexport</i> _{<i>c,t</i>} (<i>L123</i>)						18.75** (8.037)
Covid19 controls	√	√	√	√	√	√
X ₂₀₁₉ ×Month FE	√	√	√	√	√	√
Country FE	√	√	√	√	√	√
Month FE	√	√	√	√	√	√
<i>lnexport</i> _{<i>c,2019</i>} ×Month FE	√					
<i>lnexport</i> _{<i>c,2018-2019</i>} ×Month FE		√				
<i>lnexport</i> _{<i>c,2017-2019</i>} ×Month FE			√			
Observations	2,115	2,115	2,115	2,115	2,115	2,115
R-squared	0.991	0.991	0.991	0.991	0.991	0.991

Note: The values in parentheses represent country level clustered robust standard errors. The variables *Sony* is absorbed by the country fixed effects. The variable *Post* is absorbed by the month fixed effects. In the regression, we multiply dependent variable *lnexport* by 100. The variable *lnexport*_{*c,t*} (*L1*) represents the logarithm of export value from one year prior. The variable *lnexport*_{*c,t*} (*L12*) represents the sum of export values from one and two years prior, taking the logarithm. The variable *lnexport*_{*c,t*} (*L123*) represents the sum of exports from one, two, and three years prior, taking the logarithm. The variable *lnexport*_{*c,2019*} represents the logarithm of the value of China's exports to each destination country in 2019. The variable *lnexport*_{*c,2018-2019*} represents the logarithm of the value of China's exports to each destination country from 2018 to 2019. The variable *lnexport*_{*c,2017-2019*} represents the logarithm of the value of China's exports to each destination country from 2017 to 2019. *, **, and *** indicate statistical significance at the 10%, 5%, and 1% levels, respectively.

Appendix Table D3: Placebo test results – China's exports prior to the study period

	(1)	(2)	(3)
	$\ln export_{c,t(L1)}$	$\ln export_{c,t(L12)}$	$\ln export_{c,t(L123)}$
<i>Sony</i> × <i>Post</i>	0.0953 (0.0745)	0.0211 (0.0615)	0.0555 (0.0478)
Covid19 controls	√	√	√
X ₂₀₁₉ ×Month FE	√	√	√
Country FE	√	√	√
Month FE	√	√	√
Observations	2,115	2,115	2,115
R-squared	0.988	0.993	0.996

Note: The values in parentheses represent country level clustered robust standard errors. The variables *Sony* is absorbed by the country fixed effects. The variable *Post* is absorbed by the month fixed effects. In the regression, we multiply dependent variable *lnexport* by 100. The variable $\ln export_{c,t(L1)}$ represents the logarithm of export value from one year prior. The variable $\ln export_{c,t(L12)}$ represents the sum of export values from one and two years prior, taking the logarithm. The variable $\ln export_{c,t(L123)}$ represents the sum of exports from one, two, and three years prior, taking the logarithm. *, **, and *** indicate statistical significance at the 10%, 5%, and 1% levels, respectively.

Appendix Table D4: Placebo test results – Other companies as a placebo for Sony					
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
	<i>lnexport</i>				
<i>Nintendo</i> × <i>Post</i>	0.0875 (0.0790)				
<i>Rockstar Games</i> × <i>Post</i>		0.0843 (0.0756)			
<i>Ubisoft</i> × <i>Post</i>			0.0806 (0.105)		
<i>Supercell</i> × <i>Post</i>				-0.122 (0.0927)	
<i>Toyota</i> × <i>Post</i>					0.0106 (0.0964)
Covid19 controls	√	√	√	√	√
X ₂₀₁₉ ×Month FE	√	√	√	√	√
Country FE	√	√	√	√	√
Month FE	√	√	√	√	√
Observations	2,115	2,115	2,115	2,115	2,115
R-squared	0.990	0.990	0.990	0.990	0.990

Note: The values in parentheses represent country level clustered robust standard errors. In the regression, we multiply dependent variable *lnexport* by 100. The variables *Nintendo*, *Rockstar Games*, *Ubisoft*, *Supercell*, and *Toyota* respectively represent the topic GTI of the companies Nintendo, Rockstar Games, Ubisoft, Supercell, and Toyota, which are absorbed by the country fixed effects. The variable *Post* is absorbed by the month fixed effects. *, **, and *** indicate statistical significance at the 10%, 5%, and 1% levels, respectively.

Appendix Table D5: Placebo test results – Exports of other countries as a placebo for China's exports

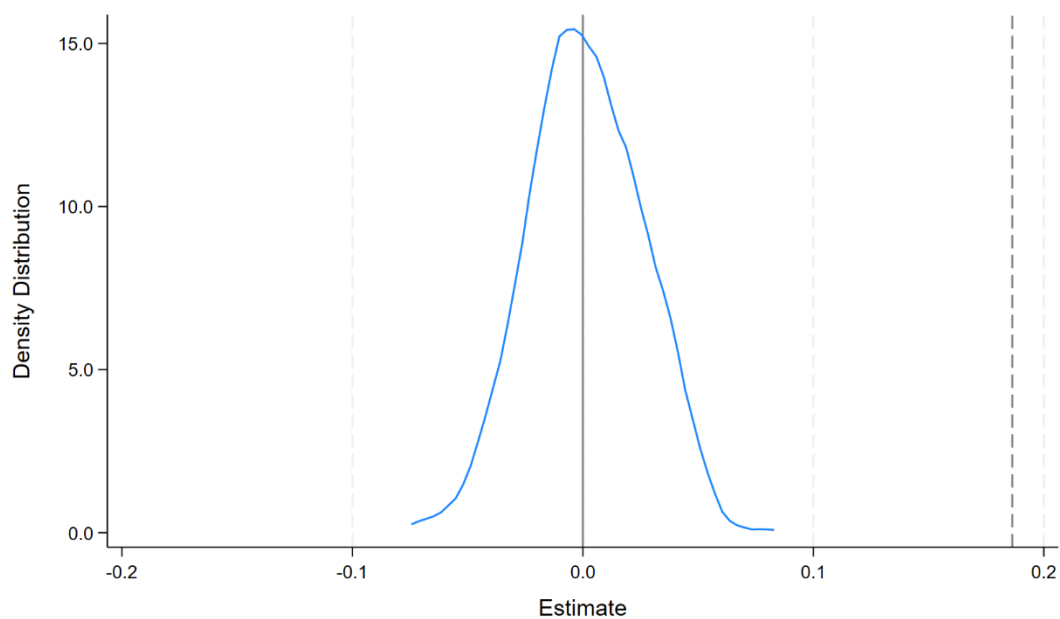
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
	<i>lnexport</i>			
	Japan JPN	Korea KOR	Vietnam VNM	India IND
<i>Sony</i> × <i>Post</i>	-0.261 (0.200)	-0.363** (0.180)	0.0280 (0.141)	-0.139 (0.163)
Covid19 controls	√	√	√	√
<i>X</i> ₂₀₁₉ ×Month FE	√	√	√	√
Country FE	√	√	√	√
Month FE	√	√	√	√
Observations	2,115	2,115	2,115	2,115
R-squared	0.915	0.937	0.999	0.963

Note: The values in parentheses represent country level clustered robust standard errors. The variables *Sony* is absorbed by the country fixed effects. The variable *Post* is absorbed by the month fixed effects. In the regression, we multiply dependent variable *lnexport* by 100. *, **, and *** indicate statistical significance at the 10%, 5%, and 1% levels, respectively.

Appendix Table D6: Additional robustness checks

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
	<i>lnexport</i>			
<i>Sony</i> × <i>Post</i>	0.621** (0.278)	0.190** (0.0773)		
<i>Genshin Impact</i>			0.215*** (0.0786)	0.215*** (0.0783)
<i>PlayStation</i>				-0.00250 (0.137)
Covid19 controls	√	√	√	√
X ₂₀₁₉ ×Month FE	√	√	√	√
Country FE	√	√	√	√
Month FE	√	√	√	√
Country FE×Month		√		
Observations	2,115	2,115	2,115	2,115
R-squared	0.991	0.992	0.991	0.991

Note: The values in parentheses represent country level clustered robust standard errors. The variables *Sony* is absorbed by the country fixed effects. The variable *Post* is absorbed by the month fixed effects. In the regression, we multiply *lnexport* by 100 to directly interpret the core estimated coefficient as a semi-elasticity. In Column (1), the variable *Sony* represents the raw Sony GTI, without normalization. The variables *Genshin Impact* and *PlayStation* are the destination country–month-level relative GTIs for Genshin Impact and PlayStation, respectively. *, **, and *** indicate statistical significance at the 10%, 5%, and 1% levels, respectively.



Appendix Figure D1: Permutation test results

Note: Appendix Figure D1 presents the density distribution of the placebo estimated coefficients from the 500 random assignments.

We obtained data from the Pew Global Attitudes & Trends database, which includes two rounds of surveys measuring public sentiment toward China in the respondent countries—Summer 2020 and Spring 2021. The question posed to respondents was: "Please tell me if you have a very favorable, somewhat favorable, somewhat unfavorable, or very unfavorable opinion of...China." The database provides the number of respondents who selected "Very favorable", "Somewhat favorable", "Somewhat unfavorable", "Very unfavorable", and "DK/Refused" for each country. The Summer 2020 survey was conducted prior to the global release of Genshin Impact (September 28, 2020), while the Spring 2021 survey was conducted afterward. Both surveys fall within the study period, making them ideal data for examining the impact of Genshin Impact on the public's sentiment toward China in the respondent countries. Unfortunately, only 13 countries participated in both the Summer 2020 and Spring 2021 surveys. This issue will be discussed in Section 4.3. Detailed data is provided in Appendix Table D7.

Appendix Table D7: Summer 2020 and Spring 2021 surveys in Pew Global Attitudes & Trends database

Country	Study	year	Very favorable	Somewhat favorable	Somewhat unfavorable	Very unfavorable	DK/Refused
Australia	Spring 2021	2021	4	17	34	44	1
Belgium	Spring 2021	2021	4	24	38	29	5
Britain	Spring 2021	2021	4	23	32	31	10
Canada	Spring 2021	2021	3	20	36	37	4
France	Spring 2021	2021	4	25	43	23	5
Germany	Spring 2021	2021	4	17	47	24	8
Italy	Spring 2021	2021	7	31	33	27	3
Japan	Spring 2021	2021	2	8	41	47	2
Netherlands	Spring 2021	2021	3	21	40	32	4
S. Korea	Spring 2021	2021	2	20	49	28	1
Spain	Spring 2021	2021	11	28	39	18	4
Sweden	Spring 2021	2021	1	17	48	32	2
United States	Spring 2021	2021	1	19	37	39	3
Australia	Summer 2020	2020	1	14	36	45	3
Belgium	Summer 2020	2020	3	21	39	32	4
Britain	Summer 2020	2020	3	19	39	35	3
Canada	Summer 2020	2020	3	20	36	37	4
France	Summer 2020	2020	4	22	44	26	3
Germany	Summer 2020	2020	2	23	48	23	5
Italy	Summer 2020	2020	7	31	36	26	1
Japan	Summer 2020	2020	0	9	34	52	5
Netherlands	Summer 2020	2020	3	22	44	29	2
S. Korea	Summer 2020	2020	1	23	46	29	1
Spain	Summer 2020	2020	10	26	34	29	2
Sweden	Summer 2020	2020	1	13	49	36	2
United States	Summer 2020	2020	3	19	31	42	6

Source: Pew Global Attitudes & Trends database

Appendix Table D8: Country List in Pew Global Attitudes & Trends (I)

Spring 2010	Spring 2011	Spring 2012	Spring 2013	Spring 2014	Spring 2015
Argentina	Brazil	Brazil	Argentina	Argentina	Argentina
Brazil	Britain	Britain	Australia	Bangladesh	Australia
Britain	China	China	Bolivia	Brazil	Brazil
China	Egypt	Czech Rep.	Brazil	Britain	Britain
Egypt	France	Egypt	Britain	Chile	Burkina Faso
France	Germany	France	Canada	China	Canada
Germany	India	Germany	Chile	Colombia	Chile
India	Indonesia	Greece	China	Egypt	China
Indonesia	Israel	India	Czech Rep.	El Salvador	Ethiopia
Japan	Japan	Italy	Egypt	France	France
Jordan	Jordan	Japan	El Salvador	Germany	Germany
Kenya	Kenya	Jordan	France	Ghana	Ghana
Lebanon	Lebanon	Lebanon	Germany	Greece	India
Mexico	Lithuania	Mexico	Ghana	India	Indonesia
Nigeria	Mexico	Pakistan	Greece	Indonesia	Israel
Pakistan	Pakistan	Poland	Indonesia	Israel	Italy
Poland	Palest. ter.	Russia	Israel	Italy	Japan
Russia	Poland	Spain	Italy	Japan	Jordan
S. Korea	Russia	Tunisia	Japan	Jordan	Kenya
Spain	Spain	Turkey	Jordan	Kenya	Lebanon
Turkey	Turkey	United States	Kenya	Lebanon	Malaysia
United States	Ukraine		Lebanon	Malaysia	Mexico
	United States		Malaysia	Mexico	Nigeria
			Mexico	Nicaragua	Pakistan
			Nigeria	Nigeria	Palest. ter.
			Pakistan	Pakistan	Peru
			Palest. ter.	Palest. ter.	Philippines
			Philippines	Peru	Poland
			Poland	Philippines	Russia
			Russia	Poland	S. Africa
			S. Africa	Russia	Senegal
			Senegal	S. Africa	S. Korea
			S. Korea	Senegal	Spain
			Spain	S. Korea	Tanzania
			Tunisia	Spain	Turkey
			Turkey	Tanzania	Uganda
			Uganda	Thailand	Ukraine
			United States	Tunisia	United States
			Venezuela	Turkey	Venezuela
				Uganda	Vietnam
				Ukraine	
				United States	
				Venezuela	
				Vietnam	

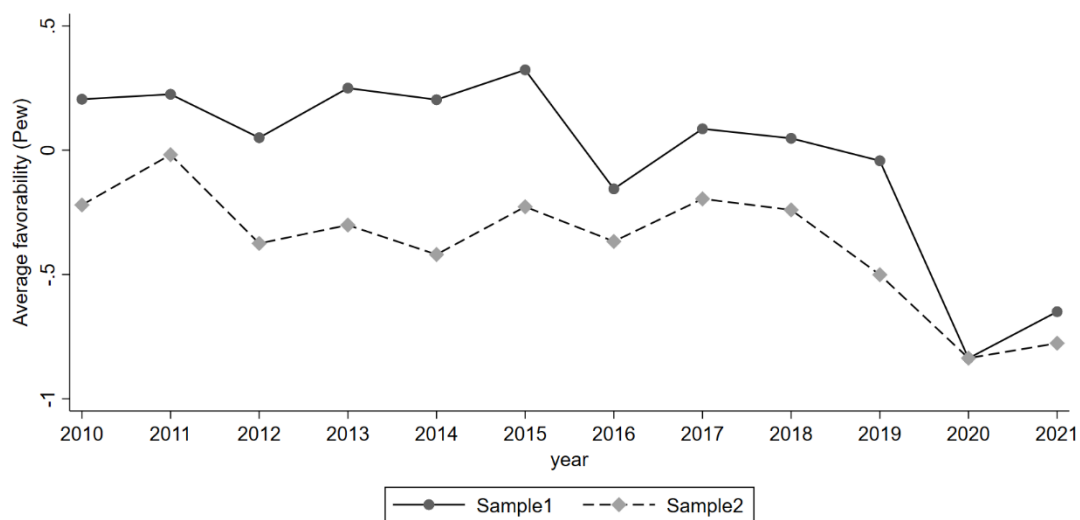
Source: Pew Global Attitudes & Trends database

Appendix Table D9: Country List in Pew Global Attitudes & Trends (II)

Spring 2016	Spring 2017	Spring 2018	Spring 2019	Summer 2020	Spring 2021
Australia	Argentina	Argentina	Argentina	Australia	Australia
Britain	Australia	Australia	Australia	Belgium	Belgium
Canada	Brazil	Brazil	Brazil	Britain	Britain
China	Britain	Britain	Britain	Canada	Canada
France	Canada	Canada	Bulgaria	Denmark	France
Germany	Chile	France	Canada	France	Germany
Greece	Colombia	Germany	Czech Rep.	Germany	Greece
Hungary	France	Greece	France	Italy	Italy
India	Germany	Hungary	Germany	Japan	Japan
Italy	Ghana	Indonesia	Greece	Netherlands	Netherlands
Japan	Greece	Israel	Hungary	S. Korea	New Zealand
Netherlands	Hungary	Italy	India	Spain	Singapore
Poland	India	Japan	Indonesia	Sweden	S. Korea
Spain	Indonesia	Kenya	Israel	United States	Spain
Sweden	Israel	Mexico	Italy		Sweden
United States	Italy	Netherlands	Japan		Taiwan
	Japan	Nigeria	Kenya		United States
	Jordan	Philippines	Lebanon		
	Kenya	Poland	Lithuania		
	Lebanon	Russia	Mexico		
	Mexico	S. Africa	Netherlands		
	Netherlands	S. Korea	Nigeria		
	Nigeria	Spain	Philippines		
	Peru	Sweden	Poland		
	Philippines	Tunisia	Russia		
	Poland	United States	S. Africa		
	Russia		S. Korea		
	S. Africa		Slovakia		
	Senegal		Spain		
	S. Korea		Sweden		
	Spain		Tunisia		
	Sweden		Turkey		
	Tanzania		Ukraine		
	Tunisia		United States		
	Turkey				
	United States				
	Venezuela				
	Vietnam				

Source: Pew Global Attitudes & Trends database

To illustrate the prior trends in China's favorability captured by the Pew data, we assign scores of 2, 1, -1, and -2 to responses of "Very favorable", "Somewhat favorable", "Somewhat unfavorable", "Very unfavorable" respectively, and calculate the annual average favorability. Appendix Figure D2 presents the average China favorability calculated from the Pew Global Attitudes & Trends database. Sample 1 includes all surveyed countries, while Sample 2 includes only the 13 countries in our regression sample (Summer 2020 and Spring 2021). Appendix Figure D2 shows that the overall favorability in Sample 1 is above zero, whereas it is below zero in Sample 2. Furthermore, the overall trends in China favorability are similar between the two samples. Prior to 2018, there are fluctuations but the trend is relatively stable; after 2018, there is a slight decline. In 2020, favorability drops sharply, likely due to discrimination and stigma associated with the COVID-19 pandemic in China (Hswen et al., 2021; Cao et al., 2023). Within the context of this study and the Pew data, the significant reduction in anti-China sentiment associated with Genshin Impact is particularly meaningful for China. This is because: (i) during the study period, respondents' favorability toward China declined substantially; and (ii) prior to the study period, countries in Sample 2 exhibited overall lower favorability toward China compared with countries in Sample 1.



Appendix Figure D2: China's national image based on Pew Global Attitudes & Trends database

Note: The data come from the Pew Global Attitudes & Trends database. The 2020 survey was conducted in the summer, while surveys in all other years were conducted in the spring. We assign scores of 2, 1, -1, and -2 to the responses "Very favorable", "Somewhat favorable", "Somewhat unfavorable" and "Very unfavorable" respectively, and calculate the annual average favorability. Sample 1 includes all surveyed countries, whereas Sample 2 includes only the 13 countries used in the regressions reported in Appendix Table D10 (Summer 2020 and Spring 2021).

We estimate a simple two-period DiD model, as specified in Equation (4).

$$Y = \alpha + \beta_1 Sony_c \times Post_t + \beta_2 Sony_c + \beta_3 Post_t + \delta_c + \theta_t + \varepsilon_{c,t} \quad (4)$$

Unlike Equation (1), Equation (3) is specified over two periods, $t = \{1,2\}$, where the first period ($t=1$) corresponds to the Summer 2020 survey and the second period ($t=2$) to the Spring 2021 survey. The indicator variable $Post_t$ takes the value 0 for $t=1$ and 1 for $t=2$. The dependent variable Y represents either the number or proportion of respondents in each country who selected "Very favorable", "Somewhat favorable", "Somewhat unfavorable", or "Very unfavorable" in their views toward China. We include destination country fixed effects δ_c and month fixed effects θ_t to account for unobserved heterogeneity across countries and months, respectively. Standard errors are clustered at the destination country level.

We report the regression results using the number of respondents as the dependent variable in Table 3, Panel A. We find that the coefficient on the "Somewhat unfavorable" category is significantly negative at the 1% level. This indicates that Genshin Impact significantly reduced the number of respondents who expressed a "Somewhat unfavorable" view of China in high-treatment countries relative to low-treatment countries. We find no evidence of significant changes in the number of respondents selecting other response categories. Panel B in Table 3 presents the results using the share of respondents as the dependent variable. The qualitative conclusions are similar: Genshin Impact significantly reduced the proportion of respondents who viewed China as "Somewhat unfavorable." Although we do not find evidence that Genshin Impact improved favorable perceptions of China, we do find evidence that it reduced unfavorable perceptions. This effect is primarily driven by a decline in mild aversion; there is no significant change in strong aversion. This result is intuitive—individuals who strongly dislike China are unlikely to revise their views solely because of a video game.

Appendix Table D10: Regression results based on the Pew Global Attitudes & Trends database

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
Answer	very favorable	somewhat favorable	somewhat unfavorable	very unfavorable
Panel A	Number			
<i>Sony</i> × <i>Post</i>	0.00640 (0.0133)	0.0174 (0.0418)	-0.108*** (0.0307)	0.0371 (0.0314)
Country FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Period FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Observations	26	26	26	26
R-squared	0.948	0.936	0.940	0.960
Panel B	Proportion			
<i>Sony</i> × <i>Post</i>	0.00801 (0.0138)	0.0258 (0.0433)	-0.0902** (0.0300)	0.0564 (0.0352)
Country FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Period FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Observations	26	26	26	26
R-squared	0.946	0.933	0.940	0.962

Note: The values in parentheses represent country level clustered robust standard errors. The variables *Sony* is absorbed by the country fixed effects. The variable *Post* is absorbed by the month fixed effects. The dependent variables represents either the number or proportion of respondents in each country who selected "Very favorable", "Somewhat favorable", "Somewhat unfavorable", or "Very unfavorable" in their views toward China, which are derived from the Pew Global Attitudes & Trends database. *, **, and *** indicate statistical significance at the 10%, 5%, and 1% levels, respectively.

Appendix Table D11: Regression results based on cultural and ICT goods (introducing the product dimension)

	(1) <i>export</i>	(2) <i>export01</i>	(3) $\ln(\text{export} > 0)$	(4) <i>quantity</i>	(5) $\ln \text{price}$
Panel A	Cultural goods and non-cultural goods				
<i>Sony</i> × <i>Post</i> × <i>culture</i>	0.00422 (0.00263)	0.000121 (0.000684)	0.00127 (0.00377)	0.00893*** (0.00251)	-0.104 (0.111)
<i>Sony</i> × <i>Post</i> × <i>Non-culture</i>	0.00220 (0.00168)	0.000630 (0.000546)	0.00462* (0.00255)	0.00874*** (0.00183)	0.0799 (0.0498)
Observations	5,293,904	5,309,880	3,074,913	5,248,795	3,047,716
Pseudo/R-squared	0.97	0.577	0.796	0.9755	0.893
Panel A	ICT goods and non-ICT goods				
<i>Sony</i> × <i>Post</i> × <i>ICT</i>	-0.000714 (0.00184)	0.000398 (0.000720)	0.00228 (0.00424)	0.0107*** (0.00309)	0.0152 (0.167)
<i>Sony</i> × <i>Post</i> × <i>Non-ICT</i>	0.00339* (0.00188)	0.000612 (0.000544)	0.00454* (0.00255)	0.00751*** (0.00264)	0.0733 (0.0499)
Observations	5,293,904	5,309,880	3,074,913	5,248,795	3,047,716
Pseudo/R-squared	0.97	0.577	0.796	0.9755	0.893
Covid19 controls	√	√	√	√	√
$\mathbf{X}_{2019}$ ×Month FE	√	√	√	√	√
Country-product FE	√	√	√	√	√
Product-month FE	√	√	√	√	√

Note: The regression data in Table D11 is at the level of China-destination country-product-month. The values in parentheses represent country level clustered robust standard errors. The variables *culture* and *Non-culture* are based on the HS6-level list of cultural products provided by the UNESCO (United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization) Framework for Cultural Statistics (FCS). The variables *ICT* and *Non-ICT* are based on the HS6-level ICT product list provided by UNCTAD (United Nations Conference on Trade and Development) ICT goods categories and composition. Columns (1) and (4) use the Poisson Pseudo-Maximum Likelihood (PPML) method. In columns (3) and (5), we multiply $\ln(\text{export} > 0)$ and $\ln \text{price}$ by 100 to directly interpret the core estimated coefficient as a semi-elasticity. *, **, and *** indicate statistical significance at the 10%, 5%, and 1% levels, respectively.

Appendix Table D12: the role of geographic gravity (geographical distance)

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
	<i>lnexport</i>				
<i>lndistance1</i> × <i>Sony</i> × <i>Post</i>	-0.260 (0.180)				
<i>lndistance2</i> × <i>Sony</i> × <i>Post</i>		-0.287 (0.185)			
<i>lndistance3</i> × <i>Sony</i> × <i>Post</i>			-0.215 (0.189)		
<i>lndistance4</i> × <i>Sony</i> × <i>Post</i>				-0.248 (0.202)	
<i>contig</i> × <i>Sony</i> × <i>Post</i>					0.519 (0.445)
<i>Sony</i> × <i>Post</i>	0.119 (0.0750)	0.118 (0.0752)	0.120 (0.0745)	0.121* (0.0723)	0.121 (0.0752)
<i>lndistance1</i> × <i>Post</i>	12.68** (6.116)				
<i>lndistance2</i> × <i>Post</i>		13.85** (6.216)			
<i>lndistance3</i> × <i>Post</i>			10.18 (6.399)		
<i>lndistance4</i> × <i>Post</i>				11.91* (6.628)	
<i>contig</i> × <i>Post</i>					-22.35* (11.97)
Covid19 controls	√	√	√	√	√
<i>X</i> ₂₀₁₉ ×Month FE	√	√	√	√	√
Country FE	√	√	√	√	√
Month FE	√	√	√	√	√
Observations	2,010	2,010	2,010	2,010	2,010
R-squared	0.990	0.990	0.990	0.990	0.990

Note: The values in parentheses represent country level clustered robust standard errors. In the regression, we multiply *lnexport* by 100. The variable *lndistance1* is the logarithm of population-weighted distance between most populated cities (harmonic mean). The variable *lndistance2* is the logarithm of population-weighted distance between most populated cities (arithmetic mean). The variable *lndistance3* is the logarithm of simple distance between most populated cities. The variable *lndistance4* is the logarithm of simple distance between capital city. The variables *lndistance1*, *lndistance2*, *lndistance3*, and *lndistance4* are all measured in km. The variable *contig* is a binary indicator that indicates whether two countries share a border. The variables *lndistance1*, *lndistance2*, *lndistance3*, *lndistance4*, and *contig* are all obtained from the CEPII database (Conte et al., 2022). *, **, and *** indicate statistical significance at the 10%, 5%, and 1% levels, respectively.

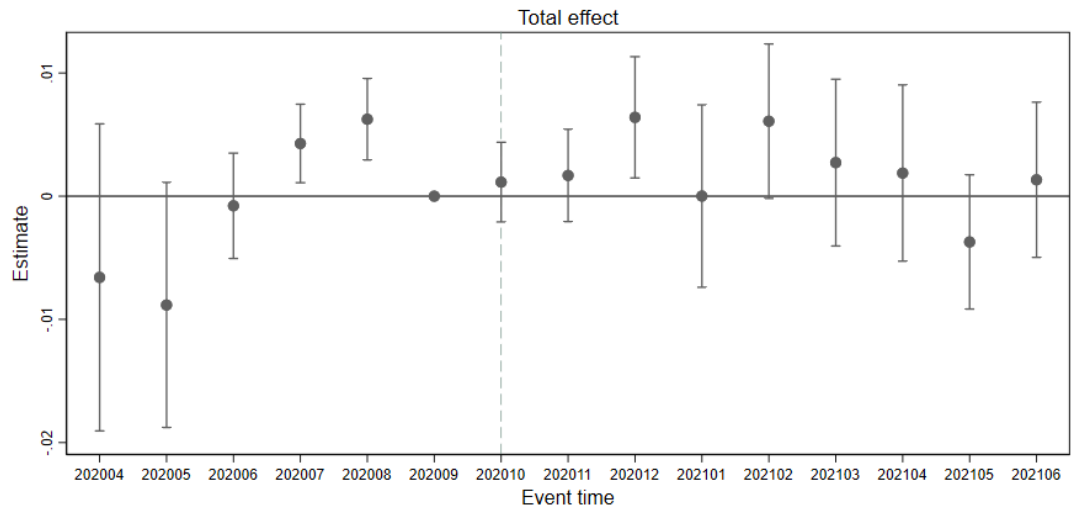
Appendix Table D13: the role of cultural gravity (cultural distance) (I)				
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)
	<i>lnexport</i>			
<i>Indistance1</i> × <i>Sony</i> × <i>Post</i>	-0.0134 (0.0114)			
<i>Indistance2</i> × <i>Sony</i> × <i>Post</i>		-0.0230* (0.0135)		
<i>Indistance3</i> × <i>Sony</i> × <i>Post</i>			-0.105 (0.0809)	
<i>Indistance4</i> × <i>Sony</i> × <i>Post</i>				-0.141 (0.102)
<i>Sony</i> × <i>Post</i>	0.109 (0.108)	-0.210* (0.120)	0.129 (0.109)	-0.192 (0.121)
<i>Indistance1</i> × <i>Post</i>	0.349 (0.303)			
<i>Indistance2</i> × <i>Post</i>		0.914* (0.541)		
<i>Indistance3</i> × <i>Post</i>			3.432* (2.048)	
<i>Indistance4</i> × <i>Post</i>				5.155 (4.218)
Covid19 controls	√	√	√	√
<i>X</i> ₂₀₁₉ ×Month FE	√	√	√	√
Country FE	√	√	√	√
Month FE	√	√	√	√
Observations	1,365	825	1,365	825
R-squared	0.992	0.993	0.992	0.993

Note: The values in parentheses represent country level clustered robust standard errors. In the regression, we multiply *lnexport* by 100. To measure bilateral cultural distance, we use the 6-D model of national culture index provided by Hofstede (2011). The variables *Indistance1*, *Indistance2*, *Indistance3*, and *Indistance4* are cultural distance by calculating the absolute value of the difference in indices between China and other countries. The variables *Indistance1* and *Indistance2* followed the method outlined by Gorodnichenko et al. (2024). We first compute the absolute value of the differences for the six dimensions and then take the average. The variable *Indistance1* does not require all six dimensions to be available, while the variable *Indistance2* requires all six dimensions to be present. The variables *Indistance3* and *Indistance4* followed the method outlined by Kogut and Singh (1988). Specifically, $distance = \text{mean}[\sum_i^6 index_i^2 / (\text{Var}(index_i))^2]$. "Here, *mean()* denotes the arithmetic mean function, and *Var()* denotes the variance function. Similarly, The variable *Indistance3* does not require all six dimensions to be available, while the variable *Indistance4* requires all six dimensions to be present. *, **, and *** indicate statistical significance at the 10%, 5%, and 1% levels, respectively.

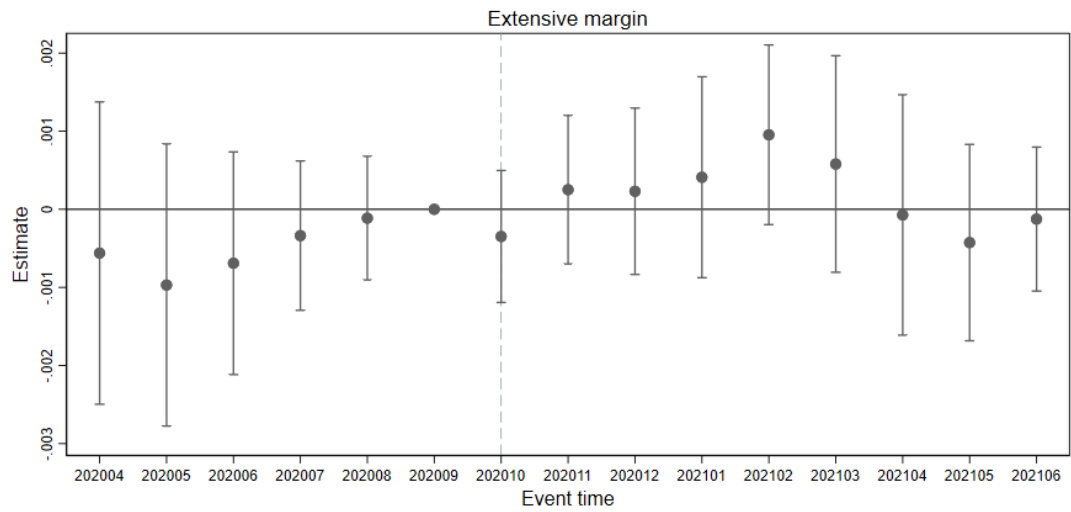
Appendix Table D14: the role of cultural gravity (cultural distance) (II)

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
	<i>lnexport</i>					
<i>PDI</i> × <i>Sony</i> × <i>Post</i>	-0.00502 (0.00665)					
<i>IDV</i> × <i>Sony</i> × <i>Post</i>		-0.00253 (0.00534)				
<i>MAS</i> × <i>Sony</i> × <i>Post</i>			-0.00268 (0.00446)			
<i>UAI</i> × <i>Sony</i> × <i>Post</i>				-0.00465 (0.00776)		
<i>LTOWVS</i> × <i>Sony</i> × <i>Post</i>					0.000565 (0.00458)	
<i>IVR</i> × <i>Sony</i> × <i>Post</i>						-0.0152** (0.00592)
<i>Sony</i> × <i>Post</i>	-0.0981 (0.0886)	-0.0705 (0.0931)	-0.0999 (0.0942)	0.0176 (0.138)	0.174 (0.115)	0.123 (0.0973)
<i>PDI</i> × <i>Post</i>	0.0730 (0.239)					
<i>IDV</i> × <i>Post</i>		-0.0371 (0.200)				
<i>MAS</i> × <i>Post</i>			-0.0725 (0.259)			
<i>UAI</i> × <i>Post</i>				0.343 (0.376)		
<i>LTOWVS</i> × <i>Post</i>					0.00458 (0.176)	
<i>IVR</i> × <i>Post</i>						0.544** (0.209)
Covid19 controls	√	√	√	√	√	√
<i>X</i> ₂₀₁₉ ×Month FE	√	√	√	√	√	√
Country FE	√	√	√	√	√	√
Month FE	√	√	√	√	√	√
Observations	915	915	915	915	1,245	1,260
R-squared	0.994	0.994	0.994	0.994	0.993	0.992

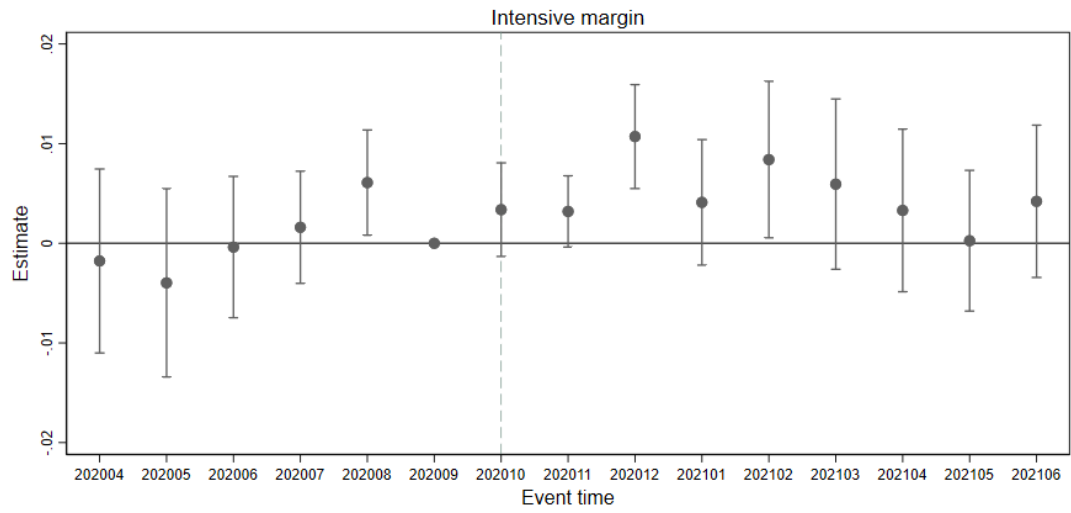
Note: The values in parentheses represent country level clustered robust standard errors. In the regression, we multiply *lnexport* by 100. The variables *PDI* (Power Distance), *IDV* (Individualism), *MAS* (Masculinity), *UAI* (Uncertainty Avoidance), *LTOWVS* (Long-term Orientation), and *IVR* (Indulgence) are the 6-D model of national culture index provided by Hofstede (2011). For detailed definitions of each index, see Hofstede (2011) or website (<https://geerthofstede.com/culture-geert-hofstede-gert-jan-hofstede/6d-model-of-national-culture/>). *, **, and *** indicate statistical significance at the 10%, 5%, and 1% levels, respectively.



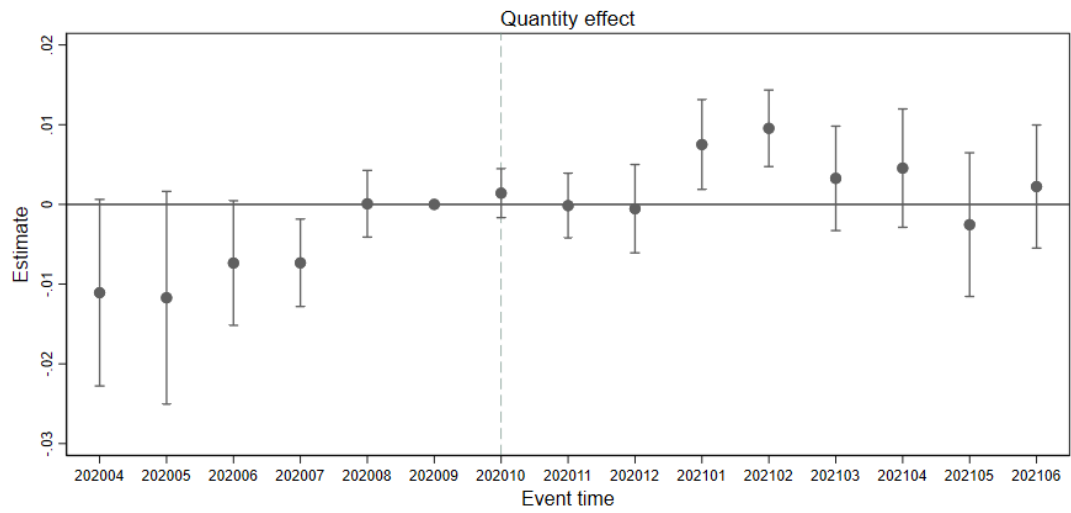
Appendix Figure D3: "Event study results of total effect (China–destination country–product–month level)



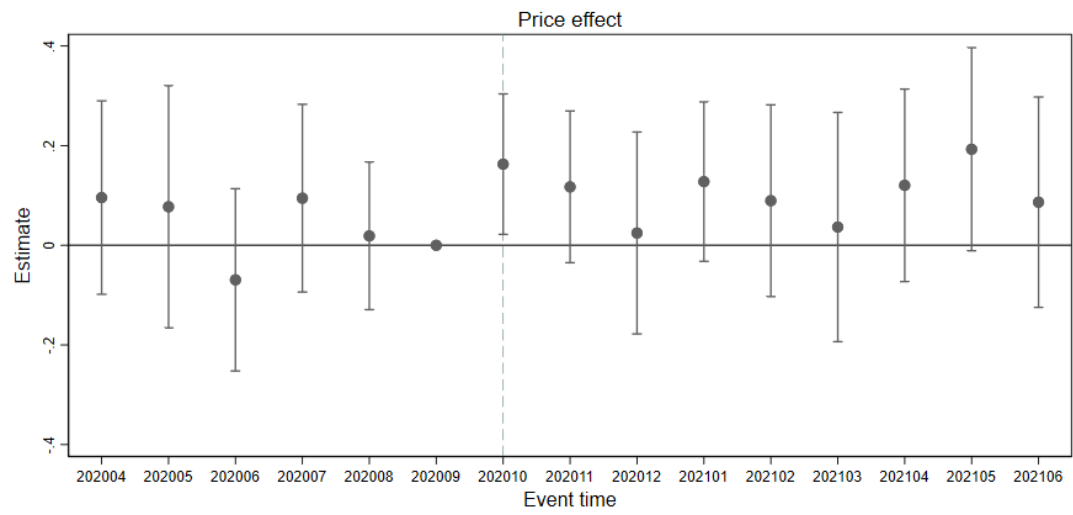
Appendix Figure D4: "Event study results of extensive margin (China–destination country–product–month level)



Appendix Figure D5: "Event study results of intensive margin (China–destination country–product–month level)



Appendix Figure D6: "Event study results of quantity effect (China–destination country–product–month level)



Appendix Figure D7: "Event study results of price effect (China–destination country–product–month level)"